Reflection

A game for 1 to 6 players by Christophe Delaforge, based on an original idea by Jean-François Mainguet

Goal of the game

In each round, a puzzle is randomly generated. Place the items of your stock on the grid so that the path of each laser matches the clue displayed on the edge. The fastest player to solve the puzzles wins the game.

Material



Mirrors, which reflect the lasers.



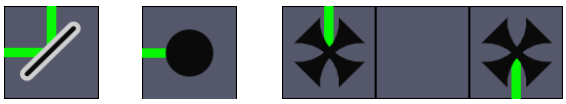
Depending on the options, mirrors of special shapes: squares and triangles.



Black holes (depending on the options), which absorb the lasers.



Light warps (depending on the options): two light warps are already placed on the grid. A laser entering one warp comes out of the other.



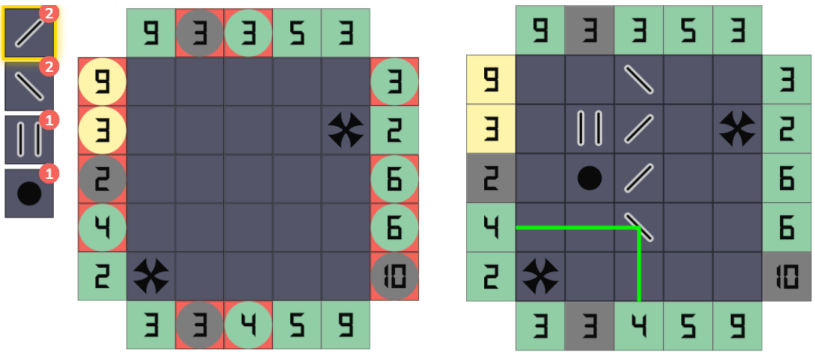
The clues

Each cell on the edge of the grid projects a laser. Its clue gives the number of cells the laser travels, and its color tells how the path ends:

- Green: the laser exits through another cell.
- Yellow: the laser exits through the same cell.
- Grey: the laser is absorbed by a black hole.

As long as your grid does not match a clue, the clue is round, on a red cell.

At any time, click on a clue to display the path of its laser on your grid.



How a round is played

- When you are ready, click on “Start”: the puzzle appears and your clock starts.
- Select an item in the stock (it is framed in yellow), then click on a cell of the grid. The number of items left is shown on each pile. You can also drag items from the stock to the grid, or from one cell to another.
- A click on an item in the grid sends it back to the stock. An item placed on an occupied cell sends the item that was there back to the stock.
-  A right click on a cell (a long press on mobile) locks or unlocks it. No item can be placed on or removed from a locked cell: use it to mark the items you are sure of.
- The arrow keys and the mouse wheel change the selected item in the stock.
- The puzzle is solved as soon as all the clues are matched. Any solution is accepted, even if it differs from the expected solution or does not use all the items.
- You can give up the round. Once the time limit is reached, you give up automatically. The solution is then displayed, and your round is over once you click on Continue.
- The Settings button lets you choose the position of the stock.

Multiplayer game

All players solve the same puzzle, each on their own grid. The game is played in 1, 3 or 5 rounds. As long as a round is not over, you only see which players have finished.

In each round, players score points according to their speed. The points are shared so that a player who wins every round totals 120 points. For instance, with 3 players and one round, the fastest player scores 120 points, the second 80 and the third 40. Giving up costs 40 points.

Two players who finish in the same time score the same points. In case of a tie at the end of the game, the player with the lowest total time wins.

Solo challenge

Alone, you take up a challenge. You start with a heart. Each solved puzzle scores a point, each failure costs a heart. The challenge is won when you reach the goal, and lost on a failure when you have no heart left.

- Challenge 1 – Easy: solve 3 puzzles.
- Challenge 2 – Medium: solve 6 puzzles, with at least 10 items and at most 15 minutes per puzzle. You earn a heart on your 3rd solved puzzle.
- Challenge 3 – Hard: solve 10 puzzles, with at least 15 items and at most 10 minutes per puzzle. You earn a heart on your 5th solved puzzle.

Game options

- Grid size: from 4×4 to 12×12.
- Number of items: from 3 to 30.
- Black holes and light warps: with or without.
- Special shapes: none, squares, triangles, or squares and triangles.
- Time limit to solve a puzzle: from 2 minutes to 1 hour.
- Multiplayer: 1, 3 or 5 rounds. Solo: the challenge level.

Tip

Start by placing the items that explain the shortest paths: the other items will then be easier to place.